

SUNIL PATNAIK

GENERAL MANAGER | HOSPITALITY LEADER

Commercial Strategy | Hotel Turnaround | P&L Leadership
Ludhiana / New Delhi, India



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Hospitality leader with **25+ years of experience** across India, the Middle East and Southeast Asia. Full hotel P&L responsibility, with a record of revenue growth, profitability, hotel turnaround and guest-experience improvement across rooms, F&B, banquets and events.

24.19%

Revenue growth YoY | YTD Aug 2026

55.26%

GOP growth YoY | YTD Aug 2026

92.9%

YTD 2026 Global Review Index (GRI)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

General Manager | Park Plaza Ludhiana | Radisson Hotel Group

23 Sep 2025 - Present

TURNAROUND ACHIEVEMENTS SINCE JOINING

- Delivered **24.19% revenue growth** and **55.26% GOP growth** year-on-year for YTD through August 2026.
- Led the team to the **Radisson Hotel Group Quality Accelerator Award, Q1 2026**, following an **11.8-percentage-point year-on-year GRI improvement** in that quarter.
- Secured Tripadvisor rankings of **No. 1 for Panorama restaurant** and **No. 2 for the hotel** in Ludhiana; improved the hotel's guest reputation ranking by approximately **100 positions**.
- Achieved a **5-star FSSAI Hygiene Rating**, supported by stronger cleaning, hygiene training and audit routines.
- Grew social media followers by **30%** and reach by **50%**; recorded peak online reach of **245,275** in the February 2026 corporate review.

OPERATIONAL AND COMMERCIAL CHANGES IMPLEMENTED

- Commercial discipline:** Repositioned the hotel across corporate, MICE, weddings, social events and F&B; introduced weekly GM sales-call reporting and weekly, monthly and quarterly business reviews.
- Guest experience:** Introduced a hotel-wide programme built around People, Process and Product, strengthening interdepartmental coordination and consistency at guest touchpoints.
- Training infrastructure:** Converted an HR store into a **digital training centre / Radisson Academy Learning Centre** for online and classroom brand and SOP training, backed by departmental calendars and monthly GM-monitored training audits.
- Team engagement:** Established monthly and quarterly recognition, town halls and staff engagement initiatives to strengthen motivation and service ownership.
- Operating standards:** Instituted daily team property rounds, room and hygiene checks, weekly hotel and back-of-house audits, and scheduled deep cleaning across guest and service areas.
- Preventive upkeep:** Engaged a new pest-control agency and introduced morning and evening checks to strengthen pest-prevention monitoring and follow-up.
- Radisson brand alignment:** Completed branding corrections with Radisson support and refreshed the hotel's digital content; appointed a marketing agency and led photoshoots, video content, advertising and outlet promotions to reinforce Park Plaza's brand positioning.

Ongoing asset improvement: Oversee renovation of guest rooms, banquet facilities and the rooftop club to enhance the product and support future revenue growth.

PARK PLAZA LUDHIANA | RADISSON HOTEL GROUP (CONTINUED)

- **Financial planning and review:** Lead monthly hotel P&L reviews and revenue forecasts, supported by weekly revenue meetings and fortnightly marketing reviews.
- **Fire-safety oversight:** Incorporate twice-weekly fire-safety checks into the GM review calendar, with regular engineering and security follow-ups.
- **Finance succession planning:** Coordinate financial-controller recruitment and notice-period handover planning, with deputy coverage for day-to-day finance operations.
- **Digital guest service (in development):** Lead planning for a two-week guest-concierge pilot with a mobile-friendly guest interface and staff food-order workflow, retaining GM oversight of access and control.

F&B Manager

18 Jul 2018 - 18 Jul 2025

The Suryaa, New Delhi

- Led a **155-member team**, ensuring high standards of food and beverage service across outlets and conference and banqueting operations.
- Recorded the **best annual F&B revenue in 10 years**; developed outlet-specific strategic action plans, revenue and expense forecasts, and departmental performance objectives.
- Managed a **16,400 sq. ft. conference and banqueting facility**, supported by team leadership, targeted promotions and visibility on WeddingWire and Cvent.
- Supported hotel website maintenance and upgrades, online portals, and the hotel marketing strategy and plan.
- Launched **The Suryaa Connect** hotel loyalty programme and upgraded and relaunched the **French Crust** pastry lounge.
- Relaunched Sunday Brunch and themed brunches at Ssence, Oriental Nights and Bubbles Brunch at Sampan, and Retro Nights, Ladies' Night and Hoteliers' Night at Atrium Lounge Bar.
- Secured media coverage for the Asian Street Food Festival, Biryani Food Festival, Christmas carols and festive programmes.
- Delivered Christmas and New Year events with outstanding sales performance.
- Managed F&B sales and marketing agreements with Zomato, EazyDiner, Gourmet Passport, Nearby and Dineout, alongside bank and online portal partnerships.
- Implemented a live table management system with cover analytics, SMS marketing and reputation management to increase walk-in covers.
- Updated outlet SOPs and training plans to strengthen service delivery and operational consistency.

INTERNATIONAL HOSPITALITY LEADERSHIP**F&B In-Charge**

08 Aug 2012 - 07 Jul 2018

Mövenpick Grand Al Bustan, Dubai

- Led a **125-member team** across restaurants, bars, in-room dining, and conference and banqueting, maintaining food and beverage service standards through coaching and team development.
- Oversaw Blue Elephant (Royal Thai cuisine), Benihana (American-Japanese cuisine), Choices (international dining), Gazebo lobby lounge, Rodeo Grill restaurant and bar, and Mawal Shisha Café.
- Delivered promotional programmes including Easter and St. Patrick's themed brunches, an Argentinian steakhouse promotion and Ramadan Market Night in 2018.

Assistant F&B Manager

27 Feb 2011 - 07 Aug 2012

Burjuman Rotana, Dubai

- Grew business revenue through themed lunches; refreshed room service and all-day dining menus and helped establish a new lounge.
- Secured a corporate contract with the Chalhoub Group for **120 daily lunch covers** in the all-day dining restaurant.
- Prepared annual budgets and business forecasts, analysed revenue performance, and defined the annual F&B marketing plan with outlet-specific activities.

Outlet Manager

18 Jun 2008 - 27 Feb 2011

Swissôtel Al Murooj, Dubai

- Generated record bar sales during the **2010 FIFA World Cup** and organised weekly Tapas and Tango Nights.
- Increased average revenue from **AED 122 to AED 128** within one year and improved training audit scores from **92% to 100%** in 2010.
- Received the **MENA Best Fine Dining Restaurant Award**; maintained expertise in South American, seafood and Oriental cuisine and British pub operations.
- Organised an international Indian food festival in coordination with the Indian Consulate.

Restaurant Manager

10 Oct 2007 - 29 Feb 2008

Shangri-La Rasa Sentosa, Singapore

- Delivered a **SGD 50,000 event** in the French restaurant, its highest event revenue at the time.
- Launched Thursday Italian Staccato lunches and Sunday Champagne brunches, indoors and on the beach.
- Coordinated Chinese dinners and wedding lunches, and a Sentosa Beach Sunday brunch with **eight live counters at SGD 160 per person**, including standard beverages and sparkling wines.

Restaurant Manager

12 Apr 2007 - 09 Oct 2007

Harry's Esplanade, Singapore

- Managed bar operations in Singapore's city centre.

Assistant Service Manager

01 Jul 2005 - 01 Jan 2007

Shangri-La Eros, New Delhi

- Managed luxury dining outlets and banquet operations, enhancing service standards and brand delivery.
- Member of the hotel opening team and the **19 Oriental Avenue** opening team.

Partner & Founder

15 Dec 2001 - 01 Jun 2005

Crestar (India) Private Limited, New Delhi

Assistant Manager - F&B

03 Feb 1998 - 14 Dec 2001

The Imperial, New Delhi

- Delivered fine-dining service in a luxury heritage setting, with personalised guest engagement; member of the **Spice Route opening team**.

Captain

15 Jul 1997 - 12 Jan 1998

Eros Hotel, New Delhi

- Supported banquet and corporate business growth while maintaining operational consistency.

Guest Service Associate

22 Nov 1993 - 15 Jun 1997

Hyatt Regency, New Delhi

- Built a foundation in luxury hospitality operations, guest service and operational delivery.

EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

- Senior Management Programme - pursuing (2026-2027)**
Indian Institute of Management, Indore.
- Degree in Hotel Management, Catering Technology & Applied Nutrition (1993)**
IHM BBSR; National Council for Hotel Management and Catering Technology, New Delhi.
- MBA - Executive Master's in Business Administration (2016)**
KSBM, Mumbai. Reference: KH-04814-11427.
- Food Safety Training & Certification (2025)**
Catering Level 2 - Food Safety Supervisor.
- Group Training Techniques** - Rotana Hotels, Dubai, 01 Feb 2011.

AWARDS & RECOGNITION

- RHG Global Winner - Quality Accelerator Award (Q1 2026)** for improvement in guest experience and quality performance across the Radisson Hotel Group portfolio.
- Best Business Hotel in Ludhiana** - Annual International Tourism Awards 2025, awarded to Park Plaza Ludhiana.
- General Manager of the Year - Leadership & Vision**, Annual International Tourism Awards 2025.
- Recognition for Panorama's dining, food and service quality, alongside improved online reputation, guest satisfaction, GRI and GSS performance.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Full hotel P&L and financial leadership | Revenue strategy, ADR and RevPAR | GOP and flow-through optimisation | Luxury guest experience and brand positioning | F&B leadership and concept development | Banquet and MICE strategy | Digital distribution and reputation management | Owner and stakeholder relations | Team leadership and development

LEADERSHIP PHILOSOPHY

Leadership anchored in **Product, Process and People**, aligning guest experience, operational excellence and financial performance. Focused on sustainable profitability, a strong team culture and luxury positioning across business segments.

PROFESSIONAL REFERENCE

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